MONEY AFTER SERVICE

Start with what's on your mind.

Choose a question ↓

CO
Army veteran · new civilian job · transition snapshot

STEP 1 · PICK A QUESTION

What money question do you have?

Choose a question to get started. The sample answers use Chris's fictional case; your own question may need more details.

- Why did my paycheck change after service?
- How much money comes in and goes out?
- What should I do about a collection letter?
- What should I tackle first?
- How do I check my VA benefits?
- What should I check about health coverage?
- What happens to my retirement plan?
- How can I plan for savings?
- How do I understand my credit-card balance?

How much comes in and goes out in Chris's monthly budget?

Explain my question

Couldn't get an answer

Failed to fetch

Chris's details and local organizations are fictional. Don't paste real personal or account information.

Coming in $

$3,827

Average take-home per month

Going out ↘

$3,082

Listed monthly bills

Left over ◎

$745

Before costs not listed here

STEP 2 · SEE MONTHLY MONEY

What comes in and goes out

Chris's sample monthly picture. Change the amounts to explore; nothing is saved.

The simple monthly picture

Demo

Take-home pay minus listed bills.

Estimated amount left **$745**

Take-home	Listed bills	Left over
$3,827	$3,082	$745

Edit monthly amounts +

A biweekly check is not a monthly check. This estimate averages 26 paychecks over 12 months. Irregular expenses are not included.

The phone letter

Ask for help

Two dates, and a receipt to bring.

Nov 14: The letter's $899 settlement offer ends.

Dec 4: The letter's stated dispute deadline.

Bring: The letter and July 28 phone-return receipt. The receipt relates to an $899 fee; it does not by itself determine what is owed.

This app can't tell you whether to pay or dispute. Ask a qualified legal professional. The clinic in this fictional case is free; call to check its Nov 11 holiday hours.

CHRIS'S NEXT STEP

Call the legal clinic before going on Nov 11.

See letter details ↓

It's Veterans Day, so check that it's open. Bring the collection letter and phone-return receipt.
The letter's offer date and dispute date are different; see the details below.

Explore other money topics and tools −

OPTIONAL

Other parts of the money picture

These topics connect to everyday cash flow during a transition.

↗

Income & transition pay

Compare military compensation with civilian take-home, pay frequency, deductions, and timing between jobs.

CASE: pay stub + LES

⌂

Housing & monthly bills

Map rent, utilities, transportation, food, and other recurring costs against dependable take-home income.

CASE: $3,082 listed bills

▤

Debt & credit

Track balances, minimums, due dates, and documentation. Verify a debt claim before treating it as established.

CASE: two different letter dates

◉

Savings & resilience

Plan for near-term costs and emergencies in an amount that fits the person's actual budget and priorities.

CASE: $1,100 in savings

+

Benefits & health coverage

Check benefit continuity, eligibility questions, and coverage changes with an accredited or qualified source.

CASE: not provided—verify

%

Taxes & pay deductions

Understand withholding and payroll deductions; use payroll or a qualified tax professional for personal guidance.

CASE: federal, NJ, FICA

▥

Retirement & future goals

Review old and new plan accounts, contribution details, fees, matching, vesting, and rollover choices with plan support.

CASE: TSP + 401(k)

◇

Insurance & protection

Check health, dental, auto, life, and identity protection needs around a job or service transition.

CASE: new employer deductions

Savings goal calculator

Try an amount. This is only an estimate.

Savings goal ($) **Save each month ($)**

3000	100

At $100/month, from $1,100 saved **19 months**

OPTIONAL CHECKLIST

Other things to check during a transition

Pick only the topics that matter to you.

A holistic check-in

Mark topics to revisit. Nothing is saved when the page closes.

- [ ] List fixed bills, flexible costs, and irregular expenses.
- [ ] Check health coverage dates with the benefits office.
- [ ] Ask an accredited VSO about VA benefit questions.
- [ ] Review old TSP and new 401(k) plan details.
- [ ] Check payroll withholding and insurance deductions.
- [ ] Review credit balances and payment dates.
- [ ] Choose a savings goal that fits your budget.

FICTIONAL CASE RESOURCES

Veterans Legal Clinic at Riverbend Law School

Free help reading and responding to collection letters. The case lists Wednesday walk-ins, 1–5 PM. Confirm whether it is open Nov 11.

Riverbend Credit Counseling

Free one-hour budget review; appointments within one week.

For VA benefit questions

This case does not state Chris's eligibility. For a real person, verify benefits through VA or an accredited Veterans Service Organization representative.

All named local organizations in this demo are invented

OPTIONAL REMINDERS

Dates from the letter

These are dates quoted from this fictional letter.

Near-term: Confirm the clinic's holiday hours before making a trip.

Download date reminders

NOV 10 **Call the legal clinic**
Ask whether Wednesday, Veterans Day, hours have changed.

NOV 14 **Settlement offer date**
Letter says $899 offer ends. Not a recommendation to pay.

DEC 04 **Stated dispute deadline**
Letter says to dispute by this date; consult qualified help.

Privacy & scope: Questions and the editable money snapshot are sent to the configured OpenAI service through this app's backend to generate answers. The app keeps chat history only in page memory; OpenAI API data-handling terms apply. Don't include real account numbers or government ID numbers. This tool does not determine benefit eligibility, debt validity, or what legal or financial choice to make.